

ORCA VLN Hackathon Training Manual

Reproduce Visual-Language Navigation in OrcaLab
Simulation First • Visible Loop • Verifiable Improvements



Ego RGB



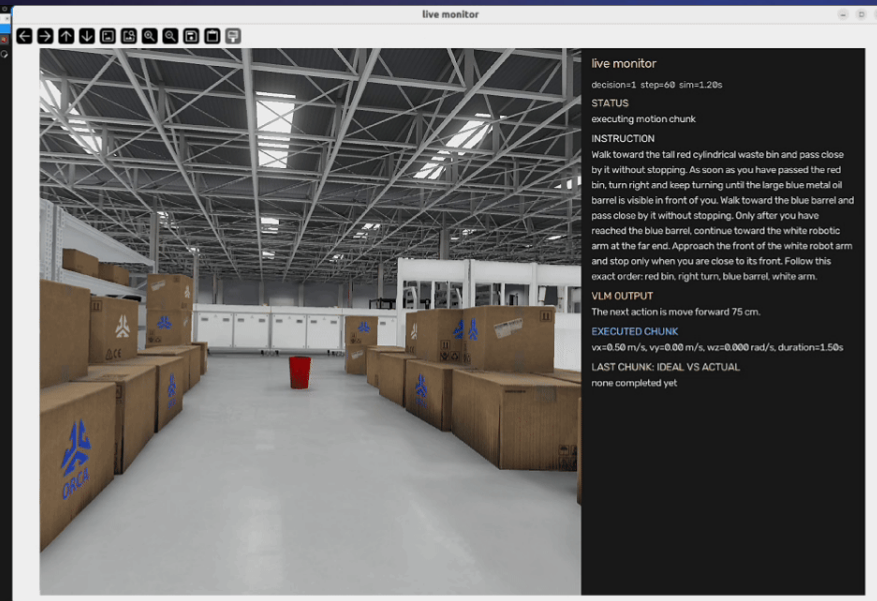
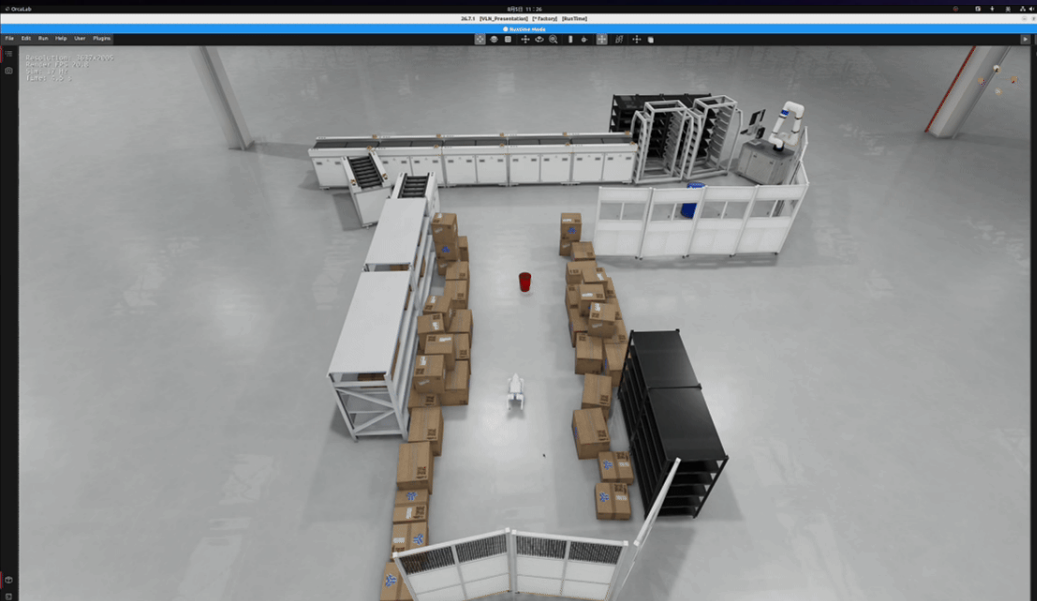
NaVILA



Velocity Command



Orca Lab



What You Will Build and Show



- 1 Instruction + 8 Ego RGB Frames $\rightarrow$ NaVILA $\rightarrow$ One Navigation Action
- 2 A Velocity Chunk Drives the Robot; the Scene Returns the Next Observation Save
- 3 RGB, Action / State Trajectories, and measurements.json



Instruction+
RGB History



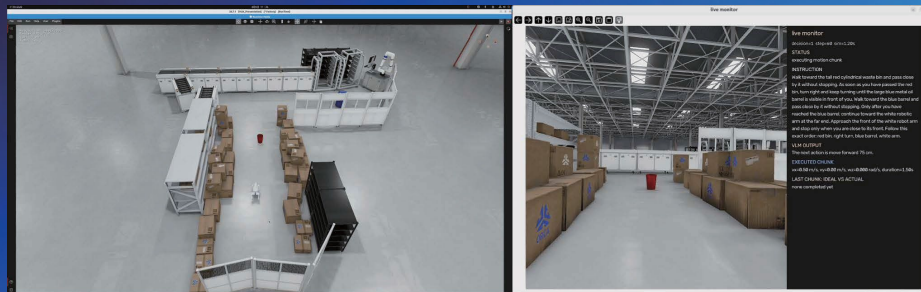
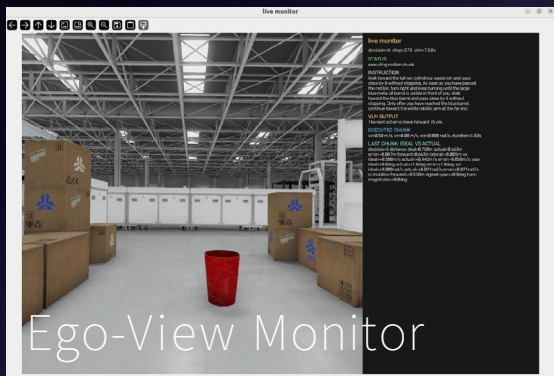
NaVILA
Baseline [1]
<http://navila-bot.github.io/>



Navigation
Action



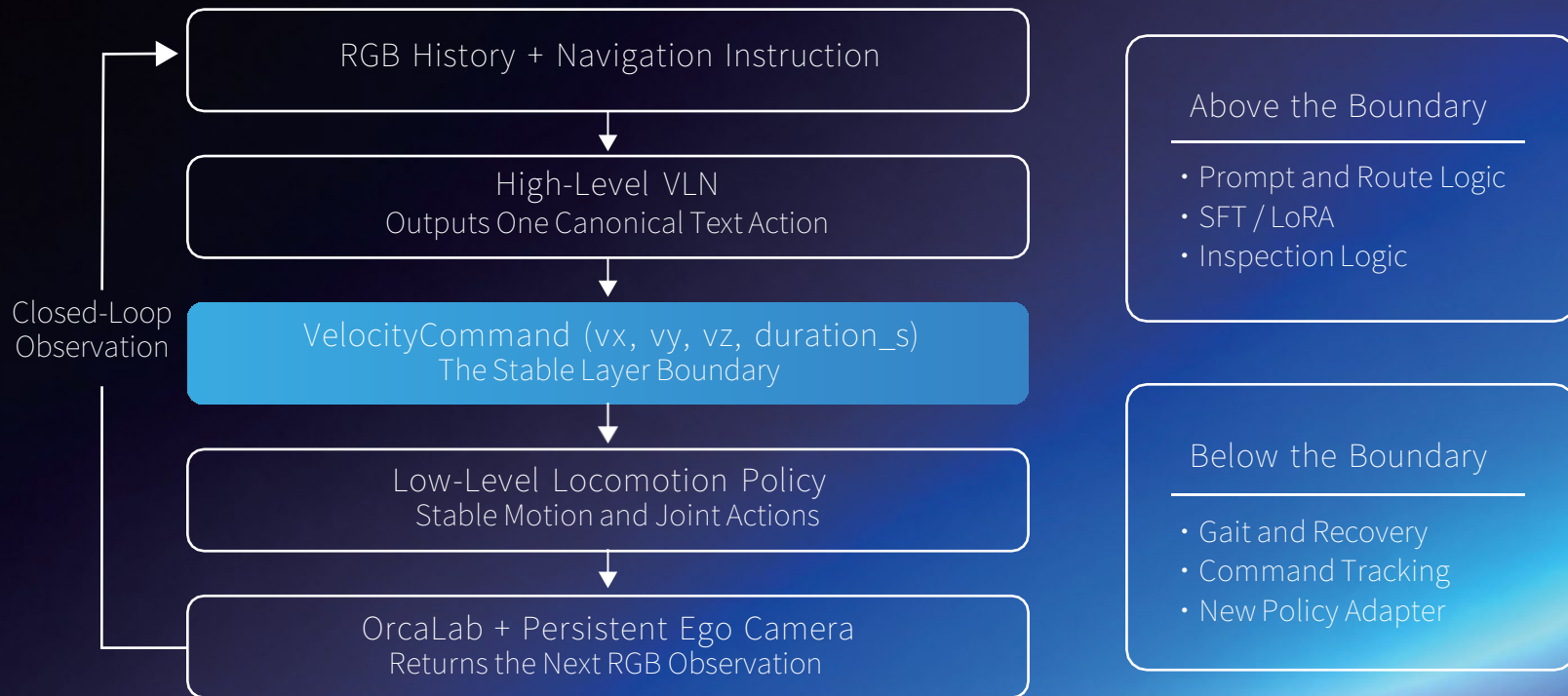
Orca Lab Returns
the Next Frame



[1] Cheng et al., NaVILA: Legged Robot Vision-Language-Action Model for Navigation, RSS 2025.

The Shared Boundary: Improve One Layer Without Breaking the Other

Teams can improve the decision model or the motion policy independently.



Keep the Velocity Command Semantics Unchanged

Separate Terminal For Testing

Run them separately to locate problems quickly.

A

Orca Lab

Open IndustrialWarehouse1_3dgs
and import default_set.json

```
./scripts/start_orcalab_gui.sh
```



B

NaVILA

Server Listening
127.0.0.1:54321

```
./scripts/start_navilm_server.sh
```



C

Run the Baseline

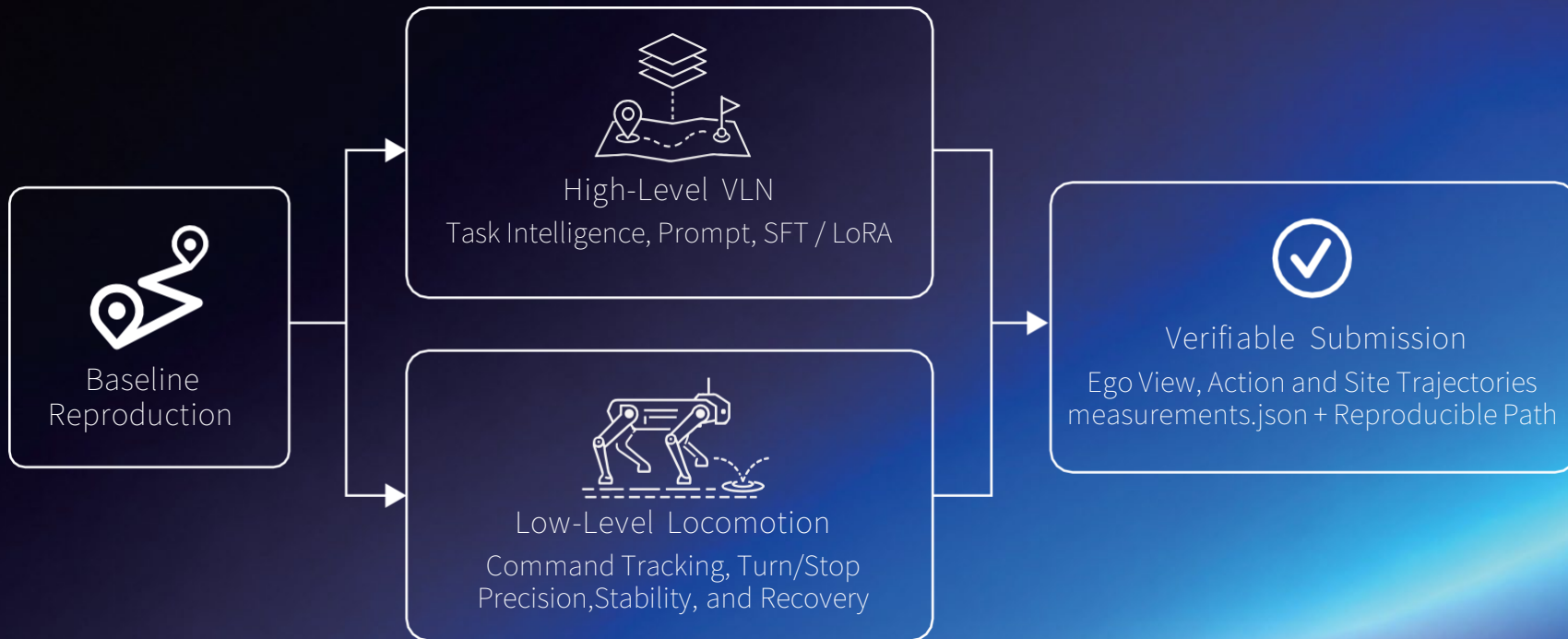
Run Closed-Loop Navigation
and Record Evidence

```
./scripts/run_orcalab_scene_locomotion.sh
```



Check First: One Complete Go2 Actor • Correct Version • Valid Model Path

Choose Your Improvement Track



High-Level VLN Adaptation: Use SFT / LoRA Carefully

1

Run Rollouts

- instruction
- image_paths
- baseline_actions



2

Human Review
Align Images with
Canonical Actions



3

SFT / LoRA
Change Only the
High-Level VLN



4

Fixed-Episode Evaluation

- Valid Actions
- Visual Grounding
- Closed-Loop Outcome



Fix the Low-Level Policy;
Save and Review Rollouts First

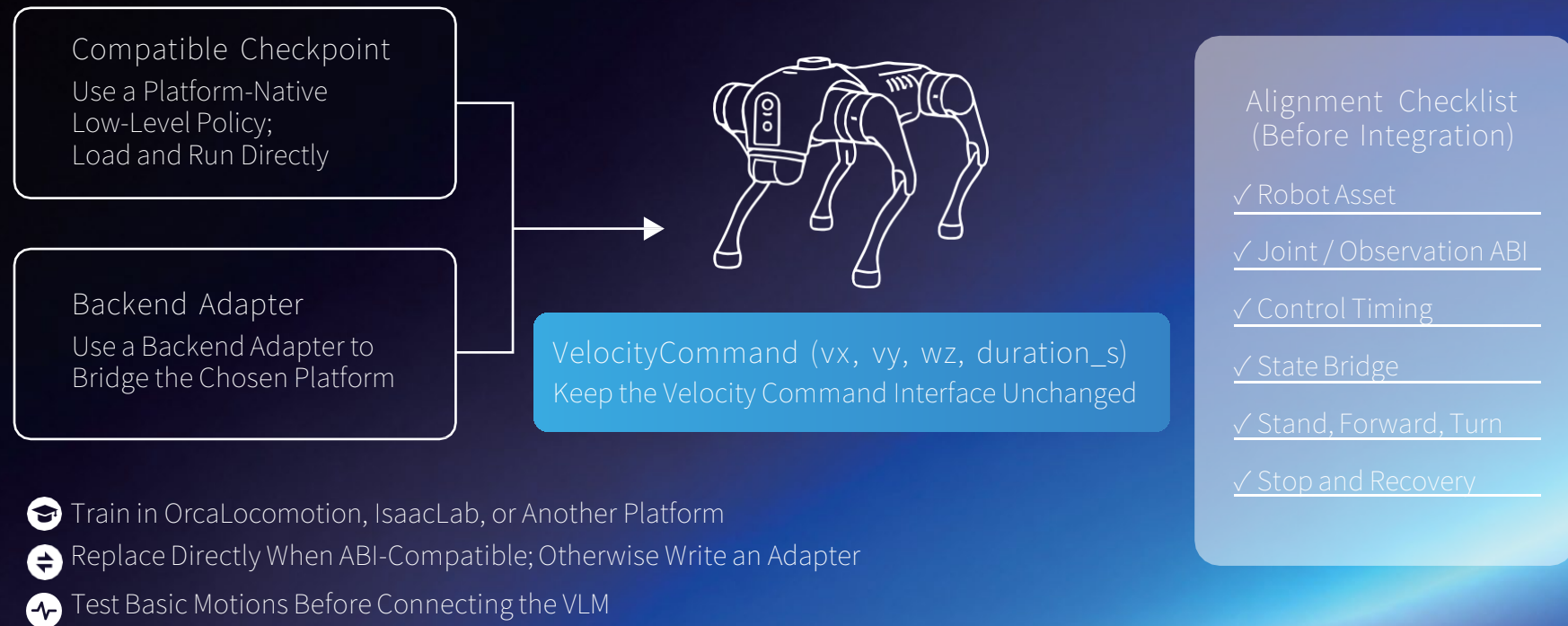


A Review Queue Is Not Ground
Truth: Label Only After
Image-Action Alignment



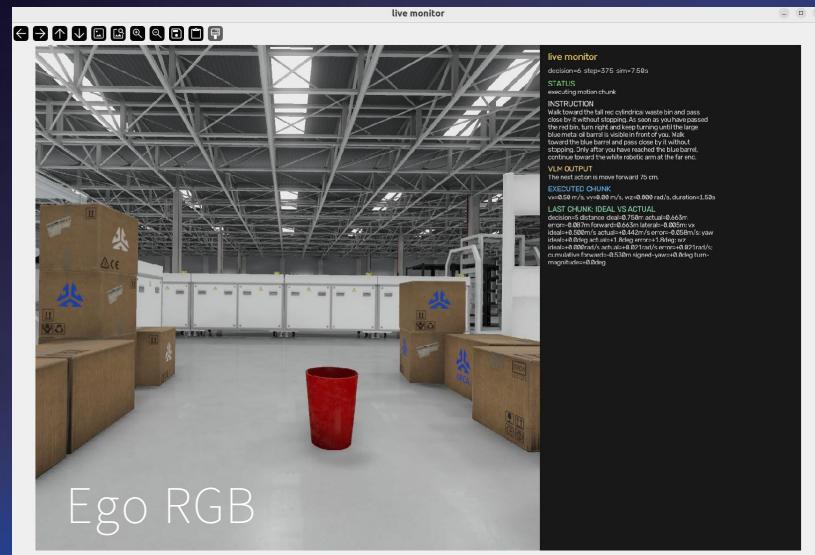
Use Fixed Scenes for Regression:
Valid Actions, Visual Ground-
ing, and Closed-Loop Outcome

Low-Level Locomotion: Train Anywhere, Integrate Precisely



Night 1

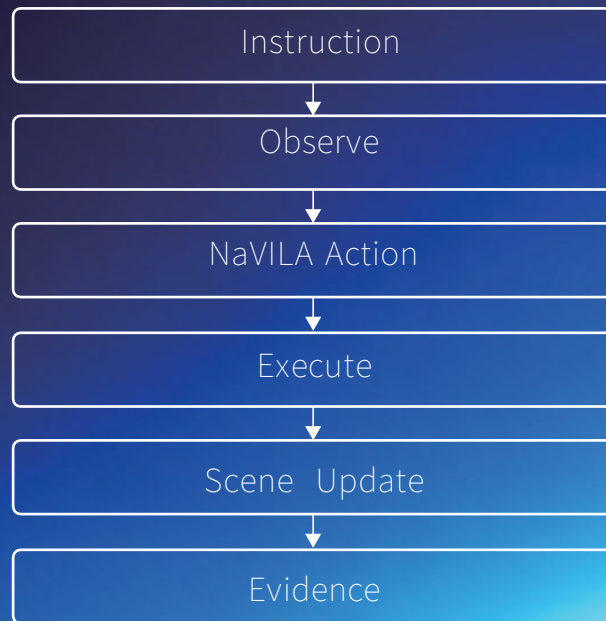
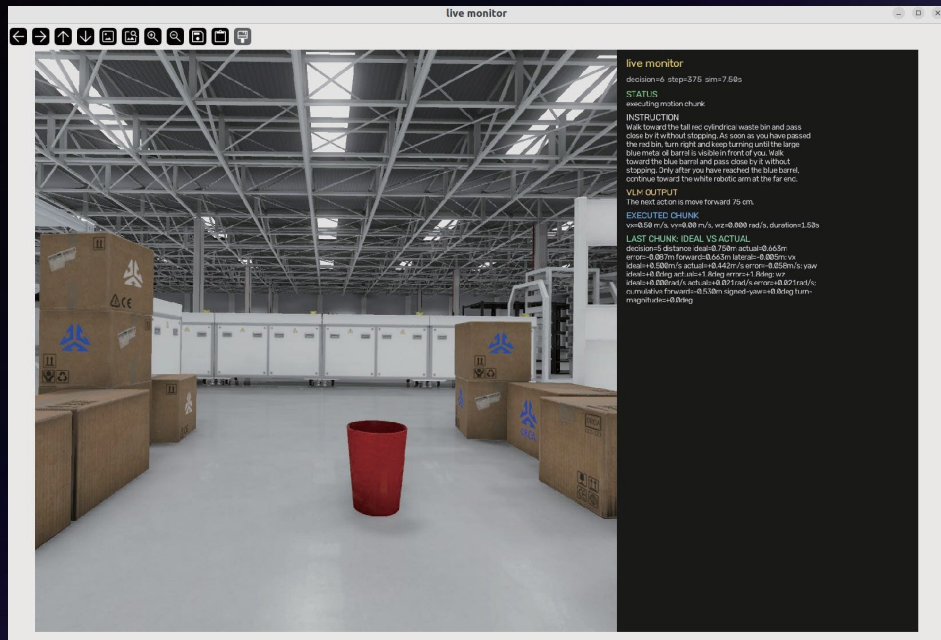
Install all the environment and open orcalab, import the scene.
Try run the demo!



- ✓ Exactly One Complete Go2 in the Factory Scene
- ✓ Create an ego camera and make sure its working
- ✓ Warm up for 100 steps to adjust start position

Night 2

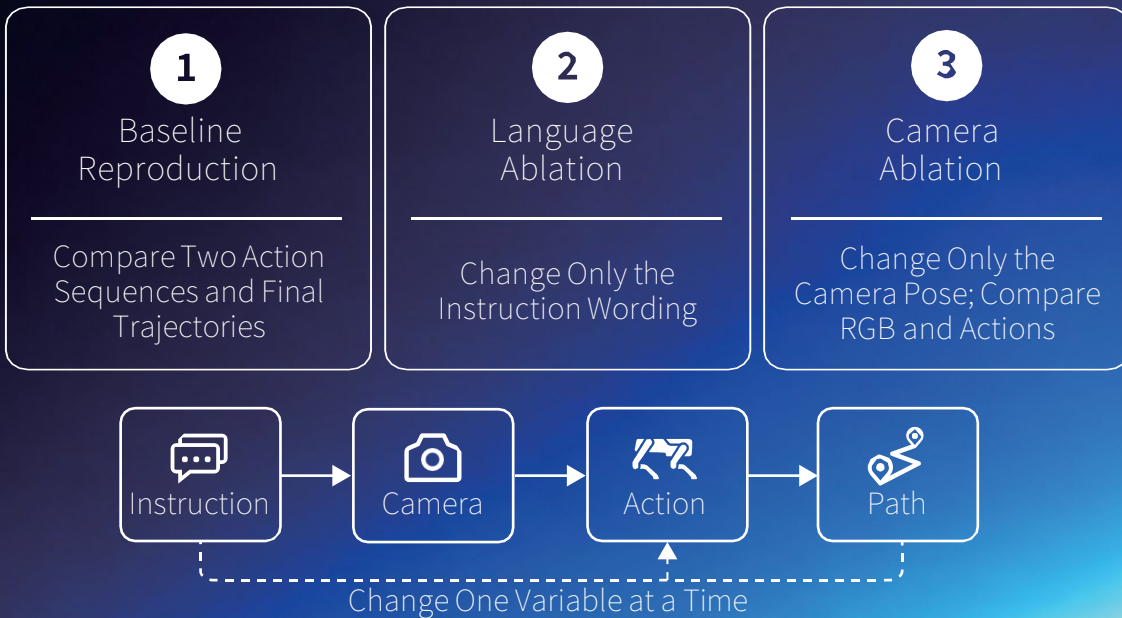
Run and Read a Closed-Loop Navigation Episode



Default task: Approach red waste bin, large blue oil barrel, white robotic arm separately.
Model returns one action chunk at one time.
Try to avoid surrounding objects.

Night 2

Improve the Baseline Without Losing Evidence



Evidence Table

Ego RGB

Action Sequence

State Trajectory

measurements.json

Make the Loop Visible and Reproducible First; Then Change One Layer at a Time.

Night 2

Improve the Baseline Without Losing Evidence



Run Path
Reproduce with One Command



Scene and Configuration
Save Configuration Notes



Run Evidence
View Images, Video, and Logs

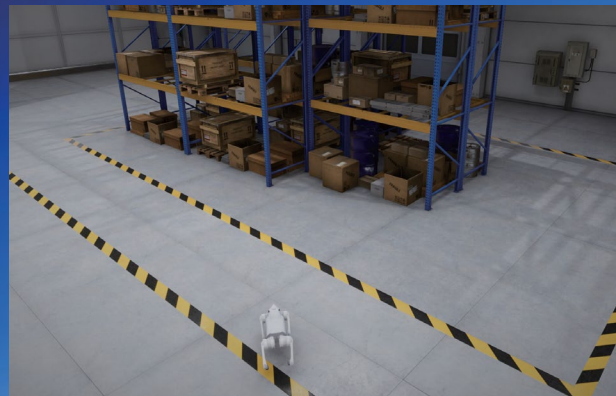


Submission Notes
Improvement Track and Baseline Comparison



Evidence Package

- Ego-View Images or Video
- measurements.json and Logs
- Replayable Run Path



Thanks for Watching

